

ANGEL ACTION · TOXICOLOGY

Poisoning

For any suspected poisoning, call the Poisons Information Centre on 13 11 26. If the person is unconscious or seriously unwell, call 000. Do not induce vomiting unless told to.

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What to do

1. Follow **DRSABCD**.
2. **Call the Poisons Information Centre on 13 11 26** (24/7, Australia-wide).
3. Call **000** if the person is unconscious, having difficulty breathing, fitting, or seriously unwell.
4. **Do NOT induce vomiting** unless specifically told to by the Poisons Information Centre.
5. Keep a sample of the poison, container or vomit for identification.
6. If unconscious but breathing, place in the **recovery position**.

Inhaled poisons (gas, smoke, fumes)

- Move the person to fresh air **only if safe** for you to do so.
- Call **000**.
- Loosen tight clothing.
- Be ready to start **CPR**.

Absorbed poisons (skin)

- Remove contaminated clothing wearing gloves.
- Flood the skin with cool running water for at least 20 minutes.
- Call Poisons or 000.

Button battery ingestion

Children swallowing a button battery is a **medical emergency**. Call **000** immediately — batteries can burn through the oesophagus within hours.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*